

DRAFT

CABLE TO AMBASSADOR WINANT FROM SECRETARY MORGENTHAU

It is urgent that you take prompt action on the following matter which has already been subject to substantial delays. Many months ago Riegner, the representative in Switzerland of the World Jewish Congress, approached this Government with a proposed plan for the evacuation of Jews from Rumania and France. The United States Treasury Department was consulted with regard to the licensing of the financial transactions involved. After carefully considering the matter, our Minister in Berne was authorized and requested to issue a license to the World Jewish Congress covering the requisite financial transactions. The proposed arrangements and the license authorized by the Treasury required that the requisite local currency be acquired either in occupied or enemy areas against blocked accounts established in the United States or Switzerland to be held until the end of the war, or in the alternative local currency might be purchased from persons in Switzerland provided the American Legation in Berne, or some other responsible agency, checked the sellers to insure that the local currency had not been acquired from objectionable sources. In general, the proposed arrangements and the Treasury license would insure that the transactions would not give benefit to the enemy. Harrison, in his cable No. 7141, November 14, which was repeated to you, refers to the objections of M.E.W. to the proposed arrangements. The British Embassy here has approached the Treasury on the matter and the Treasury is explaining the transactions and safeguards to the British Embassy. To avoid further delay please take appropriate action to obtain from M.E.W. the withdrawal of its objections to the issuance of the license and the transmittal of appropriate advice to its representative in Bern.

JWP a7L JWO REP